

Why chat bots are going to take over everything?

1. Every business is going to have a messaging bot because messaging apps will become the #1 way to communicate with other people in near future.
2. Bots will be faster than websites and mobile apps.
3. Bots are easier to use because of NLP. You don't need to find – just ask.

How can I create my own chatbot?

There are many platforms where you can build your own chatbot. They provide great user interface, drag-drop facility or an IDE to code your bot. Indian chat bot market is growing rapidly and people are engaging themselves to create more user-friendly ways to create chatbots. Below are the list of few companies those are doing great in chatbot market.

- Gupshup – Raised \$22m funding in the year 2011.
- Glomantra – Raised \$1.6m in 2008
- CogniCor – Raised \$1.07m in 2011

But can I make my bot intelligent enough to make it respond to any sort of queries?

If you want to create a simple chat bot that can do with exact word to word matching, that's not too difficult – but to understand the intent of the user and then progressing with the desired path of communication is the best way to go ahead. For this you are going to get help from various AI based platforms that are there to help you on this. If you are interested you can go and learn about

- api.ai
- wit.ai

Hubot

What is Hubot?

Hubot is a chatbot developed by GitHub, Inc to automate their everyday work that followed some specific steps to finish up. It also was a source of fun. Eventually they rewrote it and made it a open-source platform to develop bots. Today's version of hubot are written on coffeescript (that doesn't mean you have to know coffeescript to learn this) on Node.js and can be easily deployed using Heroku. More importantly hubot is a standardized way to share between everyone's bots.

Why do I need hubot?

Hubot in you company's chat room can help to perform many automation and monitoring related tasks, which you would have to do manually otherwise, undertaking steps that can be avoided with a bot. Yes, I know you can write program for that but hubot is also a program but in that you communicate via natural language – isn't that better?

Pre-requisites

As hubot is written on node.js you need to know about Node.js in a very basic level. Nothing else is required.

Getting started

You will need node and npm to install hubot. Once these two are properly installed then we can work with the hubot yeoman generator.

```
> npm install -g yo generator-hubot
```

Now from this we can create a folder and generate a new instance of hubot in it.

```
> mkdir jarvis
```

```
> cd jarvis
```

```
> yo jarvis
```

At this moment you are going to asked some question, like who is creating the bot and what adapter are you going to use. Adapters are hubots way to integrate with chat providers.

Please note – don't name your bot the 'default hubot'. This will break your application. The cause is not clear - may be some unidentified bug that hasn't been solve yet. And that's all. Nothing else is required to setup your first bot.

Now you can start up hubot by,

```
> bin/hubot
```

```
[[your_bot_name]]>
```

Now hubot comes with a set of pre-installed scripts, along with that there is a complete community of developers who are developing scripts for hubot. You can use NPM search term to search the npm registry

```
> npm search hubot-scripts [[your_search_term]]
```

Adapters

Adapters are the sets of code that allows your bot to integrate with different platforms. Hubot comes with two official adapters and quite a handful of third-party adapters including all of the popular channels.

Writing your own custom Script for hubot

Hubot out of the box doesn't do too much but it is an extensible, scriptable robot friend. There are hundreds of scripts written and maintained by the community and it's easy to write your own. You can create a custom script in hubot's scripts directory or create a script package for sharing with the community!

How to Script in hubot?

When you created your hubot, the generator also created a scripts directory. If you peek around there, you will see some examples of scripts. For a script to be a script, it needs to:

- live in a directory on the hubot script load path (src/scripts and scripts by default)
- be a .coffee or .js file
- export a function

By export a function, we just mean:

```
module.exports = function(jarvis){
```

```
/* Your bot code goes here */}
```

Each hubot script is basically a node module and the export function is bot's behaviour descriptor. In the export function you will get the bot object as a function argument. This bot object

```
jarvis> jarvis map me australia
jarvis> http://maps.google.com/maps/api/staticmap?markers=australia&size=400x400&maptype=roadmap&sensor=false&format=png
http://maps.google.com/maps?q=australia&hl=en&sl=37.0625,-95.677068&sspn=73.579623,100.371094&vpsrc=0&hnear=australia&t=m&z=11
```

One of Hubot's default scripts to call Google Maps API